COMPANY "B"
2D BATTALION(AIRBORNE) 8TH CAVALRY
1ST CAVALRY DIVISION(AIRMOBILE)
APO, San Francisco, California 96490

Prepared 6 Nov 65 concerning the action of 4 Nov 65 (1015 - 1900), vicinity coordinates 979049.

COURSE OF EVENTS

Recon Plt patrol led by Lt Ward and 17 men departed Cavalair(2/8th fwd base) at 040805 Nov 65 moving on 030 az with mission of locating and destroying a village or camp reported to be 600 - 800 m distance. Patrol followed well used footpath and at point #1, at approx 1015, discovered and captured 1 sick VC. Patrol moved approx 150m farther north in search of LZ and received light fire from vicinity of small hill (point #3). VCC evacuated from LZ by 2/8th TOC helicopter at approx 1030. Lt Ward was instruced by Lt Col Nix to maintain contact. Patrol received more fire from hill and camp area (point #2). An estimated 35 - 40 VC fled the area in small groups and individually, going in all directions; many of them unarmed. Lt Ward ordered SSG Rose's 2nd squad to secure the hill and sent SSG Jones' 3rd squad in the direction of the VC. A camp was searched and cleared. 10 sick and 2 unarmed VC were discovered in the camp and tied. SSG Jones then sent half of his squad to the hill to assist 2nd squad in destroying snipers, per SSG Rose's request for assistance. During the clearing of the hill the following became casualties: SP/4 Patterson WIA, SGT Coffey (WIA to KIA), PFC Hamill KIA. Lt Ward reported indirect fire to no avail because of proximity of enemy. Enemy handgrenades were received on the hill.

At approx 1100 Buckeye element consisting of PSG Marshall(Recon Plt Sgt) and Sgt Julian and 10 men of Co B attached to Co B departed Cavalair with the mission given by Capt Linton, CO Co B, of securing VCC, the camp, and LZ. Buckeye arrived approx 1140 and observed 10 - 12 VC running toward camp. Buckeye moved into camp under light fire from camp killing 4 - 6 VC prior to entry into camp and 4 more after entry. Buckeye under Sgt Julian then remained in camp searching, securing and assembling enemy bodies andequipment. From this time forward no effective fire was received in the camp. PSG Marshall and the remainder of SSG Jones' 3rd squad joined the Recon Plt already on the hill and at this time SGT Wilson was WIA. The western slope of the hill appeared, at this time, to be clear of VC. A body count of 8 VC dead on hill was made by SSG Rose. At 1130 Lt Trapnell XO Co B was alerted by Capt Linton to take Flanker Right (-) element consisting of 2nd plt Co A, 4 men from Co B, 1 medic, 2/8 S-2 Capt Slifer, and 1 interpter and Lt Wiest to the camp and hill area with the mission of organizing the elements already there, sweeping and securing the area and evacuating casualties. Radio contact with Lt Ward and Capt Linton was maintained during the uneventful move to the area. At approx 1230 when Flanker Right (-) was 150m short of the western slope of the camp 2nd Plt Co A was deployed on a 200m wide line and swept on an az of 50 degrees with center of zone marked by the automatic fire signals of Recon Plt at point #3 on hill. Only dead and tied VC were encountered until the plt reached a point 2/3 up the hill at which time heavy sniper fire and MG fire was received from all directions

but the west which continued with only brief lulls for approx 3 hours. The following casualties were received during this time: Recon patrol- Cpl Hill (WIA to KIA), Flanker Right (-)- Lt Parrack (Plt ldr 2nd Plt Co A) WIA, SP/4 Spencer WIA, Sgt Taylor WIA, SP/4 Frullamy WIA, Sgt Baker WIA, PFC Ortiz WIA, Sgt Be KIA. SFC Carrera (Plt Sgt 2nd Plt Co A) assumed command of plt. Capt Linton instructed Lt Trapnell to commense evacuation of casualties and hold the position. Removal of friendly WIA from the hill to the camp was slow but unsecessful in that no new casualties were taken in retreving the WIA after 2nd Plt Co A began holding on the hill. Capt Linton dispatched an M274 and litter bearers to move from Cavalair as close as possible to the action. The vehicle got within 600m of the camp and the personnel came forward from there.

At approx 1315 CO Co A Capt McElroy with 1 plt of Co A (Right Guard element) was approaching the camp area from the south with the mission of sweeping, linking up and relief. Capt Linton instruced Lt Trapnell to, upon arrival of Right Guard and link up of both Co A Plts, relinguish control of the area.to Capt McElroy and return to Cavalair with all friendly casualties, VCC, Buckeye and Recon Plt patrol. Right Guard element was approx 150m south of hill, being guided by automatic fire signals, when it began receiving increasingly severe sniper fire. Initially, Right Guard's return fire was received on the southern and western slopes of hill. Radio instructions and automatic fire signals resulted in the successful shifting of this fire to the east away from friendly elements on hill. Upon reaching a point 100m SSE of point #3 Right Guard was pinned down and unable to move in any direction or evacuate casualties. At this time arty fire from Cavalair began imparting approx 400m NE of hill(point #3). This fire was adjusted S 300m and E 200m by air at which time Capt McElroy walked it into his position. This saw the first reduction of fire being received by Right Guard but did not cease until 1750. At approx 1600 Right Guard had suffered 5 KIA and 17 WIA. Capt Linton instructed Lt Trapnell to complete evacuation of all friendly WIA, KIA if possible, VC WIA and captured enemy equipment, extract 2nd Plt Co A from hill and move it to Right Guard's position to come under Capt McElroy's command, consolidate Buckeye element and remaining Recon patrol members under Lt Wiest's command for the purpose of assisting in the evacuation of Right Guard's casualties after Flanker Right (-) and Recon patrol casualties had been turned over to the litter bearers sent forward from Cavalair, and return to Cavalair with Lt Ward to guide Co C into area later. All friendly WIA and VCC were assembled near camp, 2nd Plt extracted from the hill and moved around the western edge of LZ to Right Guard's position, and permission was requested and granted to burn the camp and all enemy equipment which could not be evacuated. This destruction was accomplished. Capt Slifer assembled some documents of interest from the camp and inspected the equipment before it was destroyed. 4 friendly KIA (all weapons reterived from bodies) had to be left on hill as attempted recovery would probably have resulted in additional friendly casualties. 1 live but sick and immobile VCC was left near camp when he collapsed because insufficient personnel were available to carry him. Evacuation by helicopter was available but not requested until Flanker Right (-) and Recon patrol reached a new secure LZ approx 300m SW of camp. Capt Slifer, all friendly WIA, and VCC were evacuated from that LZ.

At approx 1600 Lt Wiest took charge of Buckeye element and remaining Recon plt members. Buckeye continued to secure the LZ and Lt Wiest with Recon patrol moved to Right Guard and began assisting in evacuation of casualties. Lt Traynell Lt Ward and some of the original litter bearers returned by foot to Cavalair. 200m east of Cavalair at 1845 Lt Ward married up with Capt Morrison CO Co C and proceeded to guide Co C to the camp area. SP/4 Wilson (medic) who had remained with Lt Wiest was WIA later in Right Guard area. Approx 2130 Lt Wiest's element and Right Guard returned by foot to Cavalair after evacuating all WIA and KIA from their position.

The four friendly KIA on hill were evacuated the following afternoon by Sgt Cantes Co C mortar squad.

Friendly casualties inflicted on Flanker Right (-), Buckeye, and Recon patrol:
4 KIA (Sgt Coffey, Cpl Hill, PFC Hamill, Sgt Be (ARVN interpter)
9 WIA (Lt Parrack, Sgt Wilson, Sgt Baker, SP/4 Frullany, SP/4 Spencer, SP/4 Wilson, SP/4 Patterson, Sgt Taylor, PFC Ortiz)

Enemy Casualties:
20 KIA
30 WIA
5 VCC

Friendly Equipment lost:
1 M-16, 2 lensatic compasses, 1 pr binoculars, 3 LBE, armored vests of 3 KIA

Enemy Equipment captured:
13 Rifles
Documents and diaries
2 packs
1 spare MG barrel

Enemy Equipment destroyed at camp (approx)
80,000 rounds 7.62 ammo (Russian)
150 handgrenades (wooden handles)
6 rounds 57mm RR ammo
Packs and clothing for 30 - 40 men
SSG Jones reported seeing 1 57mm RR in camp but this was not captured.

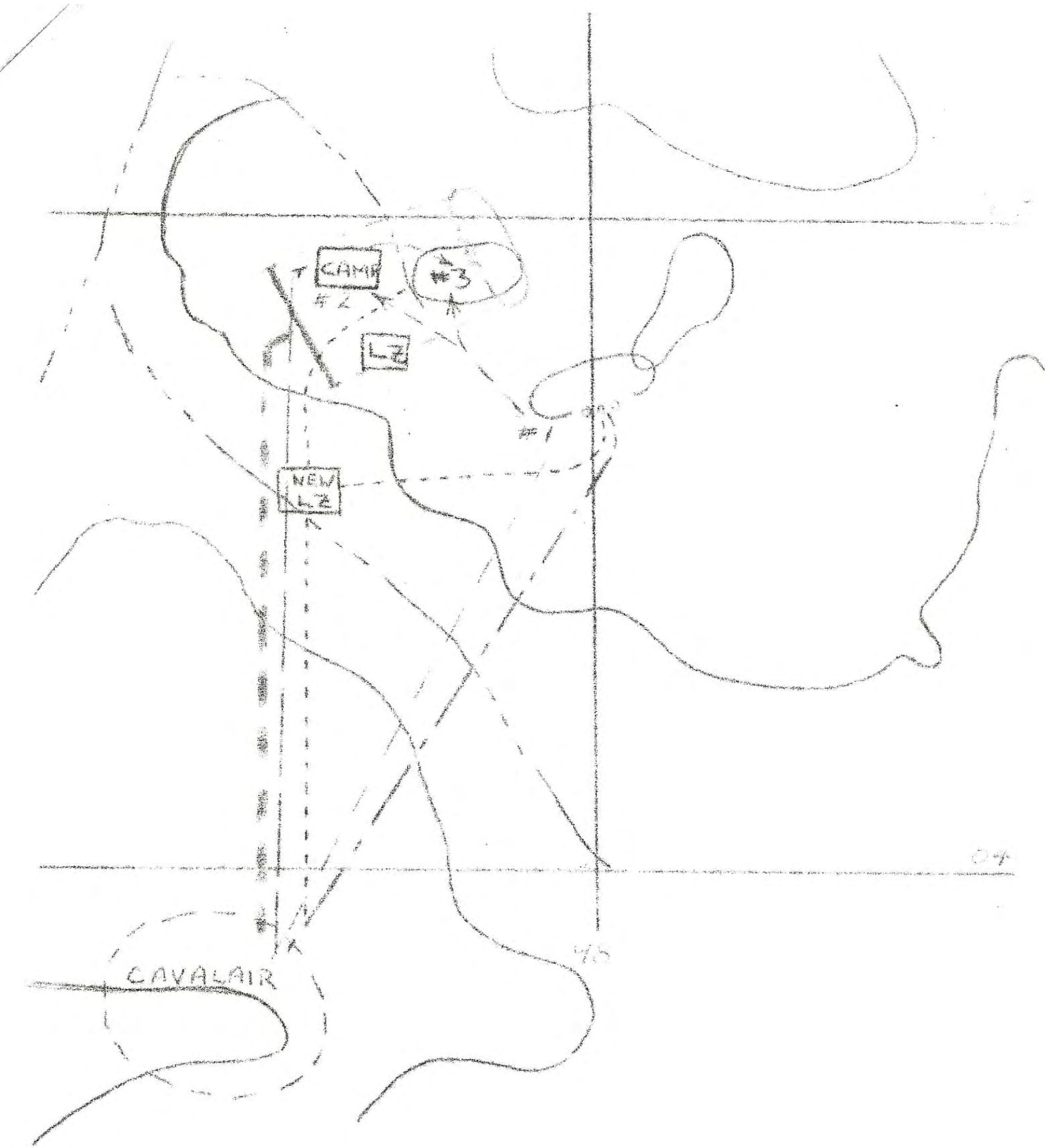
RECOMMENDATIONS FOR AWARDS

SSG Rose	Silver Star	
PFC Stenman	Silver Star	
SGT Wilson	Bronze Star w/V	
SP/4 Wilson	Bronze Star w/V	
SP/4 Patterson	Bronze Star w/V	
SGT Coffey	Bronze Star w/V	Posthumously
CPL Hill	Bronze Star w/V	" " "
PFC Hamill	Bronze Star w/V	" " "

Estimated Enemy Situation

One enemy company plus sized PAVN unit located in a rest area was surprised and abandoned in a disorganized fashion. Snipers and small groups continued to resist in the area until apprex 1700 at which time they withdrew to the north and east.

SAMUEL P LINTON III
Captain, Infantry
Commanding


CAMP
#3
LZ
#1
NEW
LZ
CAVALAIR